

POKHARA UNIVERSITY

Level: Bachelor

Semester: Spring

Year: 2025

Programme: BCSIT

Full Marks: 100

Course: Business Communication

Pass Marks: 45

Time: 3 hrs.

Candidates are required to answer in their own words as far as practicable. The figures in the margin indicate full marks.

Section "A"

Very Short Answer Questions

Attempt all the questions. [$10 \times 2 = 20$]

1. Define intra-personal communication.
2. Define plagiarism. Why should it be avoided?
3. What is an extemporaneous speech?
4. Define proxemics as a type of nonverbal communication.
5. Comment on creating a credible digital identity by an employee.
6. Write any two uses of creating a LinkedIn profile.
7. Why should one be mindful of time zones while conducting an online business meeting?
8. What do you understand by logos, pathos and ethos?
9. List salient features of a memorandum.
10. What is netiquette?

Section "B"

Descriptive Answer Questions

Attempt **any five** questions. [$5 \times 10 = 50$]

11. Explain the 7Cs of effective business communication briefly.
12. How is business writing different from other types of writing? Explain with examples.
13. What are the steps involved in a job interview? What things must we take care of before going for an interview?
14. Discuss pros and cons of digital presence. How we should be aware of its risks as a user?
15. Highlight the uses of the following visual aids for impactful communication.
 - a. Bar Diagram
 - b. Pie Chart
 - c. Organogram
 - d. Gantt Chart
 - e. Flowchart
16. Imagine that you are the secretary of a student club. Write a minute of a club meeting keeping three agendas.

Group “C”
Long Answer Questions

Attempt **any two** questions. [2×15=30]

17. Explain the process of business communication with a suitable diagram and elaborate on the essential components of communication.
18. Imagine that you want to organize a club-based program for the students of BCSIT. Create a brief proposal to submit to your college's principal for approval and financial support. (*Hints: Cover Page, Program Introduction, Objectives, Importance, Program Details, Benefited Groups, Estimated Budget, Expected Benefits, Conclusion*)
19. *Read the following case and answer the questions that follow:*

Small Heven, a Nepal-based multinational tourism company, partnered with the French travel agency Éclat Voyages to design premium tour packages for European tourists visiting Nepal. Despite the potential for success, the collaboration faced serious challenges due to intercultural communication gaps. The French team's direct communication style clashed with the Nepalese team's preference for indirect and polite expressions. This led to misunderstandings, as the French perceived the Nepalese as indecisive, while the Nepalese felt the French were overly assertive. Language barriers also played a role, as both teams communicated in English, leading to differing interpretations of key terms like "flexible itinerary."

Cultural differences in time management further strained the partnership. The Nepalese team's flexible deadline approach conflicted with the French team's strict schedule adherence, causing delays and frustration. Non-verbal communication issues added to the problems. For instance, the Nepalese team avoided direct eye contact as a sign of respect, which the French team misinterpreted as disinterest. Additionally, decision-making styles differed: while Éclat Voyages relied on hierarchical decision-making, Bright Horizons followed a consensus-driven approach, delaying the finalization of plans.

The consequences of these intercultural communication issues were significant. The launch of the tour packages was delayed by three months, causing both teams to miss the peak European travel season. This not only resulted in financial losses for Bright Horizons but also strained its relationship with Éclat Voyages. The French agency, frustrated by the inefficiencies, began reconsidering its future collaboration with the Nepalese company, highlighting the importance of bridging cultural differences for successful international partnerships.

Questions:

- a. Introduce the problem in the given case.
- b. Based on the given case, explain three barriers to intercultural communication.
- c. If you were to visit a new country for business purposes, how would you prepare yourself for effective communication across your culture?